Joseph Smith

Product leader and founder with 7+ years of experience in Austin TX, taking complex products from concept to market across AI, hardware, and enterprise software. I operate at the intersection of business strategy, product, design, and engineering, turning ambiguous opportunities into scalable products.

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KwikKart

Co-founder and CPO || October 2024 - Current

- Led product strategy for an AI-enabled smart checkout and retail intelligence platform, spanning edge AI, hardware, shopper UX, retailer SaaS, and store operations.
- Took the product from early concept → in-store pilot → commercial MVP, translating retailer needs and real-world operational constraints into product requirements and roadmap priorities.
- Defined the business and monetization strategy across retail media, SaaS, and retail intelligence.
- Led cross-functional execution across product, UX, mechanical engineering, software, embedded systems, and computer vision, coordinating development of the K-One smart-cart platform.
- Established strategic relationships with retailers, retail-data providers, and technology partners to support pilots, product validation, and commercialization.
- Validated product-market direction through multiple in-store pilots achieving 95% shopper satisfaction across 100+ users, while demonstrating opportunities across checkout, operations, retail media, and shelf intelligence.
- Owned product roadmap, requirements, prioritization, and go-to-market strategy from prototype through commercialization.

IBM SOAR Playbooks

UX Designer || June 2021 - Aug 2022

- Led re-architecture of a security automation platform to improve how SOC analysts design and execute incident response workflows by 60%.
- Simplified complex workflows into intuitive user experiences, reducing friction by 79% less time on playbook-based schemas.
- Contributed to low-code/no-code capabilities, enabling non-technical analysts to build and manage playbooks independently with 33% reduced time on custom schemas.
- Partnered with stakeholders to identify product gaps and align development with real-world security operations
- Improved platform usability and scalability, supporting broader adoption across enterprise teams
- Contributed to award-winning product design (Red Dot, iF Design, IDA Design)

IBM UEBA

Product Strategist & Lead UX Designer || Jan 2024 - Sep 2024

- Led 0→1 product definition for IBM's User and Entity Behavior Analytics initiative, translating an emerging cybersecurity opportunity into a scalable enterprise product strategy.
- Conducted competitive and market analysis to identify whitespace, customer needs, and product differentiation across the UEBA/security analytics market.
- Defined product capabilities and workflows enabling SOC analysts to assess behavioral risk, investigate anomalies, and prioritize threats.
- Translated complex behavioral and security telemetry into clear, actionable decision-support experiences for enterprise security teams.
- Partnered across product, engineering, research, and security stakeholders to move the initiative from strategic concept toward product execution.

IBM Branding & Design Systems

Lead & UX/UI Designer || Nov 2023 - Feb 2025

- Led a forward-facing initiative to define a scalable 3-tier design system
- Coached and mentored designers in Figma and scaled teams in efficiency and optimization
- Component structuring and architecting
- Helped elevate and scale IBMs' brand through their design system
- Cross org collaboration and teachings

Experience

- IBM 5 years
- KwikKart 2 years+ (current)

Education

Savannah College of Art and Design (SCAD)
B.F.A User Experience
Class of 2021

Skills

- Soft Skills
- Leadership
- Coaching
- Growth Mindset
- Systems Thinking
- Logical / Technical Thinker
- GTM strategy
- Project Management
- Product Management
- MVE to MVP
- Business Strategy
- Jobs To Be Done
- Journey Mapping
- Information Architecture
- User Testing

Achievements

- SOAR Playbooks Reddot Design Award 2022
- SOAR Playbooks iF Design Award 2023
- SOAR Playbooks IDA Design Award 2022
- Carbon Design System Reddot Award 2022
- IBM Design Award

Tools

- Figma
- Design Systems
- ChatGPT
- Claude
- Figma Weave
- Jira
- Aha
- Monday